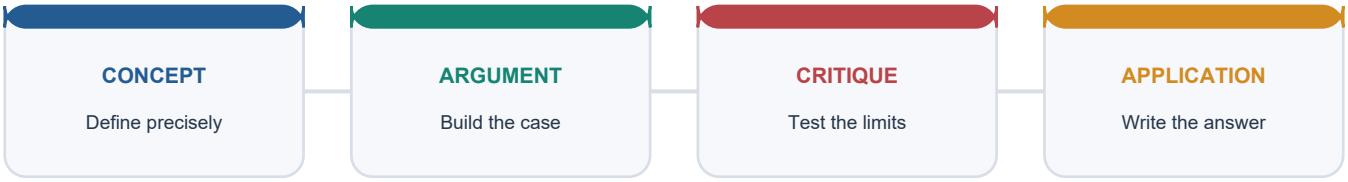
SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

The Decline of the Mughal Empire (1707-1740s) - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC solved practice workbook | 32 MCQs with explanations, verified PYQs and original Mains practice with model answers

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Decline of the Mughal Empire (1707-1740s) - Solved Practice Workbook

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Why is the phrase 'political vacuum' inadequate for 1707-1740s India?

Why is the phrase 'political vacuum' inadequate for 1707-1740s India?

A. Regional states, zamindars, Marathas and financiers exercised organised power as Delhi weakened B. No territory or revenue control changed hands during this period C. European companies withdrew from India during this period D. The emperor maintained full coercive control throughout the period

Answer: A.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Correct: this describes an active redistribution of organised authority, not an empty stage.
- **B.** Wrong: extensive territory and revenue control changed hands among regional claimants, so nothing stayed static.
- **C.** Wrong: Company commercial and later political presence expanded in this period; it did not withdraw.
- **D.** Wrong: this directly contradicts the imperial contraction that is the topic's central premise.

Trap logic: 'Vacuum' tempts an image of an empty stage; the exam-safe answer must instead name the actual claimants who filled it.

Q2. Which was a central military weakness of the later Mughal host?

Which was a central military weakness of the later Mughal host?

A. A legal prohibition on cavalry service B. Composite contingents and factional commanders lacked reliable unified coordination C. Dependence solely on European-trained infantry D. A complete absence of artillery in the imperial army

Answer: B.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong: no such prohibition existed; cavalry remained a core part of mansab-based service.
- **B.** Correct: Karnal shows how divided command nullified otherwise considerable numerical resources.
- **C.** Wrong: the later Mughal army stayed composite (cavalry, artillery, infantry, elephants), not solely European-trained.
- **D.** Wrong: Mughal forces retained artillery; the Karnal failure was of coordination, not equipment.

Trap logic: Do not reduce a command-and-coordination failure to a crude technology-deficit explanation.

Q3. Which economic statement about the period is most defensible?

Which economic statement about the period is most defensible?

A. Bengal's trade ended in 1717 B. Delhi had no commerce at all after 1739 C. Decline in imperial remittance could coexist with stronger regional treasuries and markets D. Every rupee not remitted to Delhi disappeared from circulation

Answer: C.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong: 1717 marks an expansion of Company trading privilege in Bengal, not an end to Bengal's trade.
- **B.** Wrong: Delhi and regional commerce showed resilience even after the severe 1739 shock.
- **C.** Correct: resources were redistributed toward regions even as central remittance fell.
- **D.** Wrong: revenue retained regionally still circulated within provincial markets and treasuries.

Trap logic: Treat Delhi's fiscal loss and India's overall economic condition as separate questions.

Q4. Nadir Shah's settlement with Muhammad Shah did which of the following?

Nadir Shah's settlement with Muhammad Shah did which of the following?

A. Installed the Sayyid Brothers as rulers of Delhi B. Abolished the Mughal dynasty outright C. Annexed the whole Gangetic plain to Persia D. Left Muhammad Shah on the throne while transferring wealth and frontier territories west of the Indus

Answer: D.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong: the Sayyids had already fallen from power nearly two decades earlier, in 1720, and played no role in 1739.
- **B.** Wrong: Muhammad Shah continued to reign as emperor after Nadir Shah's withdrawal.
- **C.** Wrong: no permanent Persian annexation of the Gangetic plain occurred; Nadir withdrew after plunder.
- **D.** Correct: Nadir extracted wealth and ceded frontier territory west of the Indus, then withdrew, leaving Muhammad Shah as emperor.

Trap logic: Separate plunder-and-withdrawal from territorial annexation and dynastic replacement.

Q5. Which of the following was NOT a consequence of the 1739 invasion?

Which of the following was NOT a consequence of the 1739 invasion?

A. Immediate, uniform destruction of all Indian trade and urban life B. Greater exposure of the north-western frontier C. Encouragement to provincial and local political assertion D. Severe loss of Mughal imperial prestige

Answer: A.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Correct (the false/overstated claim to identify): no evidence supports uniform destruction of all Indian trade and urban life from one invasion.
- **B.** Wrong as an answer here because this was a genuine consequence: the frontier's exposure was real and lasting.
- **C.** Wrong as an answer here because provincial assertion did intensify following the shock to central prestige.
- **D.** Wrong as an answer here because prestige loss was severe and well evidenced.

Trap logic: 'Not a consequence' questions invert ordinary recall - the correct choice is the overstated claim, not a true one.

Q6. Which causal ordering of Mughal decline is strongest?

Which causal ordering of Mughal decline is strongest?

A. Culture declined, therefore jagirs disappeared B. Fiscal strain weakened service; weak service reduced collection; lower collection intensified faction and autonomy C. Company trade ended, therefore Bengal became rich D. Nadir Shah invaded, therefore Aurangzeb fought in the Deccan

Answer: B.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong: fabricates a causal link; no evidence connects cultural change to jagir disappearance in this sequence.
- **B.** Correct: this traces the self-reinforcing fiscal-military feedback loop central to the topic's mechanism.
- **C.** Wrong: internally false, since Company trade expanded rather than ended in this period.
- **D.** Wrong: reverses chronology; Aurangzeb's pre-1707 Deccan wars could not be caused by an invasion in 1739.

Trap logic: A strong answer traces a causal loop between named mechanisms, not an arbitrary pair of unconnected events.

Q7. Which statement best captures Mughal institutional continuity after 1707?

Which statement best captures Mughal institutional continuity after 1707?

A. Every successor state abolished mansabs immediately B. The khutba lost all political meaning after 1707 C. Regional powers appropriated imperial titles, documents and revenue practices even as Delhi lost command D. Persian ceased to be used as an administrative language after 1707

Answer: C.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong: successor states typically retained and repurposed Mughal ranks and offices rather than abolishing them.
- **B.** Wrong: the khutba retained real symbolic and legitimating value even as central command weakened.
- **C.** Correct: appropriation of Mughal forms lowered the legitimacy cost of building new regional states.
- **D.** Wrong: Persian remained the chancery and administrative language well beyond 1707.

Trap logic: Institutional survival is evidence against total collapse, but it is not proof of unchanged central power.

Q8. Which is the best historiographical synthesis for this topic?

Which is the best historiographical synthesis for this topic?

A. Every region followed an identical agrarian trajectory B. No meaningful decline occurred at any level of the polity C. Only moral decay explains the crisis D. Central fiscal-military decline plus uneven regional state formation and continuing economic-cultural vitality

Answer: D.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong: contradicts the regional-variation evidence that is central to the decline-versus-transition debate.
- **B.** Wrong: denies the well-evidenced contraction of enforceable central authority.
- **C.** Wrong: personalises a structural, multi-causal institutional process.
- **D.** Correct: this two-level, regionally qualified verdict best incorporates the strongest evidence from all schools.

Trap logic: Balanced synthesis does not mean granting every competing school equal explanatory weight.

Q9. Why could Mughal legitimacy survive military contraction?

Why could Mughal legitimacy survive military contraction?

A. It remained a recognised language for title, succession, revenue rights and arbitration B. The emperor still controlled every provincial treasury C. European companies prohibited the use of local coinage D. Regional rulers maintained no armies of their own

Answer: A.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Correct: existing institutional vocabulary made imperial sanction useful even to functionally autonomous powers.
- **B.** Wrong: this contradicts the provincial fiscal autonomy documented across Bengal, Awadh and Hyderabad.
- **C.** Wrong: no such prohibition existed; regional and local coinage continued to circulate.
- **D.** Wrong: regional rulers built substantial independent military-fiscal establishments.

Trap logic: Symbolic authority can retain real transactional value even after coercive power has weakened.

Q10. Which answer line is strongest on Aurangzeb's responsibility for later decline?

Which answer line is strongest on Aurangzeb's responsibility for later decline?

A. His empire had effectively ceased to exist before his death B. His Deccan and coalition choices aggravated structural strain, but post-1707 institutions and actors determined the trajectory C. He bears no responsibility because he died in 1707 D. He alone caused every later event through his religious policy

Answer: B.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong: the empire continued to function formally for decades after 1707.
- **B.** Correct: this balances inherited strain against the independent weight of later succession, faction and jagirdari mechanisms.
- **C.** Wrong: his inherited fiscal-military strain directly shaped the conditions of the post-1707 crisis.
- **D.** Wrong: over-personalises a multi-causal structural process into one ruler's policy.

Trap logic: The strongest answer avoids both fully exonerating and wholly blaming a single ruler.

Q11. Which statement about the 'dark age' characterisation is most defensible?

Which statement about the 'dark age' characterisation is most defensible?

A. It is fully refuted by pointing to one prosperous merchant B. It proves that culture disappeared across India C. It captures real imperial and social disruption but fails as an all-region description D. It is a precise, measurable statistical category

Answer: C.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong: a single example can neither confirm nor refute an all-India generalisation.
- **B.** Wrong: cultural production continued and even flourished in Muhammad Shah's and regional courts.
- **C.** Correct: disruption was real, but uniform application across every region is unsupported.
- **D.** Wrong: 'dark age' is a rhetorical label, not a measured statistical category.

Trap logic: Use levels, regions and social groups separately rather than adopting or rejecting one verdict word.

Q12. Which distinction best captures Mughal decline after 1707?

Which distinction best captures Mughal decline after 1707?

A. Trade ceased entirely across India B. All regional states rejected every Mughal form C. The dynasty vanished immediately in 1707 D. Central enforcement weakened while dynastic legitimacy and administrative vocabulary persisted

Answer: D.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong: trade continued and regionally intensified through this period.
- **B.** Wrong: successor states actively retained Mughal titles, offices and sanction.
- **C.** Wrong: the dynasty continued in title through Muhammad Shah and later emperors.
- **D.** Correct: this states the level-specific decline the topic requires - authority, not dynasty or vocabulary, contracted.

Trap logic: 'Decline' names a level of enforceable authority, not a single moment of total disappearance.

Q13. What did the Sayyid Brothers' kingmaking primarily demonstrate?

What did the Sayyid Brothers' kingmaking primarily demonstrate?

A. Court coalitions could control accession without becoming emperors themselves B. A fixed law of primogeniture worked reliably C. Nadir Shah ruled Delhi during this period D. Jagirs became private hereditary estates

Answer: A.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Correct: the Sayyids controlled enthronement and deposition while remaining kingmakers, not emperors.
- **B.** Wrong: no binding primogeniture existed; succession remained a contested, negotiated process.
- **C.** Wrong: conflates the 1713-1720 Sayyid period with the unrelated 1739 Nadir Shah invasion.
- **D.** Wrong: jagirs remained transferable revenue assignments, not private hereditary property, throughout this period.

Trap logic: Kingmaking demonstrates the weakness of monarchical arbitration, not the abolition of monarchy itself.

Q14. Why is a high jama not proof of a strong imperial treasury?

Why is a high jama not proof of a strong imperial treasury?

A. It abolished the role of local intermediaries B. Jama was an assessed claim that could exceed realised hasil C. It recorded military victories rather than revenue D. It measured coinage in circulation only

Answer: B.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong: zamindars and revenue farmers remained central to collection regardless of the jama figure.
- **B.** Correct: a high paper assessment could mask a shrinking real treasury when hasil fell short.
- **C.** Wrong: jama is a fiscal-assessment term, unconnected to campaign or victory records.
- **D.** Wrong: jama measured an assessed revenue obligation, not the volume of circulating coin.

Trap logic: A large paper assessment can conceal a genuinely weak realised treasury.

Q15. How should Aurangzeb's Deccan wars be used in an explanatory answer?

How should Aurangzeb's Deccan wars be used in an explanatory answer?

A. As an event that occurred after Nadir Shah's invasion B. As proof that provinces possessed no political agency C. As an inherited fiscal-military strain within a wider causal interaction D. As the sole cause of all later Mughal decline

Answer: C.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong: reverses chronology; the Deccan wars precede 1707 and long predate the 1739 invasion.
- **B.** Wrong: contradicts the extensive regional political assertion this topic documents.
- **C.** Correct: the wars are best used as inherited strain combined with, not substituted for, later mechanisms.
- **D.** Wrong: over-weights one factor against succession, faction and jagirdari-agrarian mechanisms.

Trap logic: 'Inherited strain' must be integrated with later mechanisms, never used to replace them.

Q16. Which inference from growing provincial autonomy is safest?

Which inference from growing provincial autonomy is safest?

A. Every province became a fully modern nation-state B. Continued coinage proves direct Delhi taxation C. All governors stopped using imperial titles D. Governors could retain Mughal symbols while controlling practical revenue and patronage

Answer: D.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong: anachronistic; successor states operated within a Mughal-derived idiom, not as modern nation-states.

- **B.** Wrong: coin and khutba evidence show a claim to legitimacy, not administrative control or taxation.
- **C.** Wrong: most successor rulers continued using Mughal titles and sought imperial sanction.
- **D.** Correct: symbol and substantive control could diverge, exactly as seen in Bengal, Awadh and Hyderabad.

Trap logic: Symbol and substance must be evaluated as separate, not identical, forms of evidence.

Q17. What does Nadir Shah's victory at Karnal most directly reveal?

What does Nadir Shah's victory at Karnal most directly reveal?

A. Fragmented Mughal command was vulnerable to a coordinated invading force B. Mughal legitimacy disappeared on that day C. The invasion caused every earlier fiscal strain D. Persia formally annexed the Gangetic plain

Answer: A.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Correct: divided noble command could not withstand Nadir's disciplined, unified force.
- **B.** Wrong: Muhammad Shah remained emperor after Karnal; legitimacy was not extinguished by the defeat.
- **C.** Wrong: reverses causation; fiscal strain long preceded the 1739 invasion.
- **D.** Wrong: Nadir withdrew after plunder; no lasting Persian annexation of the Gangetic plain followed.

Trap logic: Karnal exposes a pre-existing weakness; it does not originate the decline that produced it.

Q18. Which actor belongs to the agrarian-regional feedback loop rather than only court politics?

Which actor belongs to the agrarian-regional feedback loop rather than only court politics?

A. Only foreign merchants operating in coastal trade B. Zamindars negotiating, resisting or withholding cooperation C. A single chronicler's rhetorical adjective D. The Peacock Throne considered as a material object

Answer: B.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong: foreign merchants were commercially significant but are not the agrarian-political actor this loop describes.
- **B.** Correct: zamindars' bargaining or resistance directly shaped the level of realised revenue.
- **C.** Wrong: a rhetorical label from a chronicle is not itself a historical political actor.
- **D.** Wrong: a material artefact, however symbolically important, is not an agrarian-political actor.

Trap logic: Do not confuse symbolic objects or narrative adjectives with the actual social actors driving the mechanism.

Q19. Which claim should be rejected in a well-constructed core answer?

Which claim should be rejected in a well-constructed core answer?

A. Jagirdari pressure affected mansabdar-service ties B. Succession wars weakened the emperor's arbitration capacity C. Aurangzeb alone explains the entire post-1707 imperial crisis D. Regional assertion followed varied, distinct routes

Answer: C.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong as the answer here because this is a true, well-evidenced claim, not one to reject.
- **B.** Wrong as the answer here because this is also a true, well-evidenced claim.
- **C.** Correct: this monocausal overstatement is the claim a well-constructed answer must explicitly reject.
- **D.** Wrong as the answer here because regional variation is an accurate and required qualification.

Trap logic: 'Reject' questions require identifying the false or overstated claim, not recalling a true one.

Q20. What is be-jagiri, precisely?

What is be-jagiri, precisely?

A. A formal title held by the provincial diwan B. A category of private freehold landownership C. A named Persian invasion route into India D. A shortage of sufficiently productive and usable jagirs for claimants

Answer: D.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong: the diwan is a fiscal-supervisory office, unrelated to be-jagiri.
- **B.** Wrong: jagirs were never private freehold property under this system.
- **C.** Wrong: this confuses a fiscal-administrative term with an unrelated military-geographic one.
- **D.** Correct: be-jagiri names the scarcity or delay of suitable assignments within the mansab-jagir system.

Trap logic: Be-jagiri names an assignment shortage, not ordinary corruption or a form of land ownership.

Q21. Why should this topic's core chronology stop in the 1740s?

Why should this topic's core chronology stop in the 1740s?

A. Later Durrani invasions and Panipat III are consequences or bridges, not this topic's core causal field B. Nadir Shah became the Mughal emperor C. Mughal institutions formally ended in 1740 D. No further significant events occurred in India after 1740

Answer: A.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Correct: the topic's causal core is bounded at the 1740s; later Abdali/Panipat material belongs to other named topics.
- **B.** Wrong: Nadir withdrew after plunder in 1739 and never became Mughal emperor.
- **C.** Wrong: institutions such as mansab, jagir and the Persian chancery persisted well beyond 1740.
- **D.** Wrong: significant later events did occur, but they lie outside this topic's bounded causal field.

Trap logic: A bounded topic must stop at its own causal field even though later, related events genuinely exist.

Q22. What is the best use of coin and khutba evidence for this topic?

What is the best use of coin and khutba evidence for this topic?

A. It makes farmans unnecessary as a source B. It can show a claim to Mughal legitimacy but not daily administrative obedience C. It proves universal economic prosperity D. It proves the existence of a modern national border

Answer: B.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong: farmans and coin/khutba evidence serve different, complementary evidentiary functions.
- **B.** Correct: coin and khutba demonstrate a claim to authority, not its day-to-day enforcement.
- **C.** Wrong: symbolic-legitimacy evidence cannot by itself establish economic conditions.
- **D.** Wrong: anachronistic; Mughal-era coinage and khutba practice do not correspond to modern national borders.

Trap logic: Symbolic evidence proves a claim to authority, not the fact of its enforcement.

Q23. Which answer structure is most defensible for a core Mains response on this topic?

Which answer structure is most defensible for a core Mains response on this topic?

A. List only the nicknames of later Mughal emperors B. Equate every region's condition with Delhi's condition C. Weigh succession, faction, fiscal-military strain, regional assertion and Nadir's shock together D. Treat Nadir Shah's invasion as the lone origin of decline

Answer: C.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong: reduces the answer to trivia and ignores the causal mechanism entirely.
- **B.** Wrong: erases the essential analytical distinction between the centre and the regions.
- **C.** Correct: the strongest structure integrates multiple mechanisms rather than isolating one factor.
- **D.** Wrong: over-weights a single external accelerant against the structural causes that preceded it.

Trap logic: The strongest Mains answers integrate several named mechanisms rather than picking a single favourite factor.

Q24. Why did short jagir tenure create recurring administrative pressure?

Why did short jagir tenure create recurring administrative pressure?

A. It converted all zamindars into salaried royal officials B. It abolished mansab-based service entirely C. It guaranteed a higher hasil for every jagirdar D. It could reward rapid extraction over durable local cooperation

Answer: D.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong: zamindars retained a distinct, locally rooted status and were not absorbed into salaried official ranks.
- **B.** Wrong: mansab-based service continued; tenure length changed incentives, not the system's existence.
- **C.** Wrong: short tenure typically discouraged investment and could lower, not guarantee, sustained hasil.
- **D.** Correct: a jagirdar with a short, uncertain tenure had incentives to extract quickly rather than invest locally.

Trap logic: Short-term incentive structures, not personal greed alone, explain the recurring extraction pattern.

Q25. What continuity most directly qualifies the image of total Mughal collapse?

What continuity most directly qualifies the image of total Mughal collapse?

A. Regional rulers continued to use Persianate offices, grants and legitimacy idioms B. Delhi no longer mattered symbolically to any regional power C. All cultural production stopped after 1707 D. No regional rulers maintained standing armies

Answer: A.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Correct: continued use of Persianate administrative and legitimacy forms is the clearest qualifying continuity.
- **B.** Wrong: this contradicts the evidence that Mughal symbols retained real political usefulness for regional rulers.
- **C.** Wrong: cultural production continued and relocated toward regional courts such as Hyderabad and Awadh.
- **D.** Wrong: regional rulers built and maintained substantial independent armies.

Trap logic: Continuity of administrative and legitimacy form is evidence against total collapse, not proof of unchanged central power.

Q26. Which wording about the 1739 sack of Delhi is methodologically safest?

Which wording about the 1739 sack of Delhi is methodologically safest?

A. It erased every regional economy across India B. It was a severe prestige and fiscal shock with contested numerical estimates C. It permits stating a single fixed casualty total without sourcing D. It established permanent Persian rule over northern India

Answer: B.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong: overstates a capital-city catastrophe into an unsupported all-India economic claim.
- **B.** Correct: severity is certain while the exact casualty/plunder totals remain contested across sources.
- **C.** Wrong: this is precisely the unsupported numerical precision this topic's source discipline warns against.
- **D.** Wrong: Nadir Shah withdrew after plunder; no permanent Persian rule over northern India followed.

Trap logic: Methodological safety requires holding severity and numerical uncertainty together, not choosing one over the other.

Q27. What most clearly separates court faction from a fixed ethnic identity in this period?

What most clearly separates court faction from a fixed ethnic identity in this period?

A. Only one factional group ever held high office B. Every noble acted solely according to birthplace C. Patronage coalitions shifted and cannot be read as permanent ethnic voting blocs D. Factional competition ended entirely in 1720

Answer: C.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong: multiple factional labels (Turani, Irani, Afghan, Hindustani) held high office across the period.
- **B.** Wrong: shifting patronage, not birthplace alone, determined factional alignment.
- **C.** Correct: faction names a flexible, shifting court-patronage bloc, not a fixed ethnic identity.
- **D.** Wrong: factional competition continued well beyond the Sayyid Brothers' fall in 1720.

Trap logic: Faction labels describe flexible court-patronage blocs, not permanent, fixed ethnic groupings.

Q28. Which factor functions as an external shock rather than an original internal mechanism?

Which factor functions as an external shock rather than an original internal mechanism?

A. Provincial retention of locally collected resources B. The jagir-realisation (jama-hasil) mismatch C. Succession conflict among Mughal princes D. Nadir Shah's 1739 invasion

Answer: D.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong: this is an internal structural mechanism, generated from within the empire's own fiscal system.
- **B.** Wrong: an internal fiscal mechanism intrinsic to the jagirdari system, not an external shock.
- **C.** Wrong: an internal political mechanism arising from the empire's own succession practice.
- **D.** Correct: the invasion originated outside the imperial system and struck an already-weakened structure.

Trap logic: Distinguish a genuinely external accelerant from the internal mechanisms it merely exposed and worsened.

Q29. What effect did regional assertion have on Mughal imperial capacity?

What effect did regional assertion have on Mughal imperial capacity?

A. It reduced reliable remittance and made central enforcement more difficult B. It instantly ended all symbolic Mughal sovereignty C. It removed all local diversity from the political map D. It guaranteed eventual Company conquest of India

Answer: A.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Correct: reduced remittance and weaker enforcement are the direct, evidenced effects of regional assertion.
- **B.** Wrong: symbolic Mughal sovereignty persisted even as practical control weakened.
- **C.** Wrong: regional assertion increased, rather than removed, local political variation.
- **D.** Wrong: Company success required additional factors - naval power, credit, alliances and Bengal revenue - beyond Mughal decline alone.

Trap logic: Regional assertion weakened the imperial centre without automatically producing one guaranteed successor power.

Q30. Which conclusion best reflects the institutional-continuity argument for this topic?

Which conclusion best reflects the institutional-continuity argument for this topic?

A. Administrative terms vanished entirely in 1707 B. Mughal political grammar outlasted Mughal capacity to command it C. Political decline ended all Persian record-keeping D. Regional autonomy required abandoning all Mughal titles

Answer: B.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong: terms such as mansab, jagir and subah persisted in use for decades after 1707.
- **B.** Correct: this is the precise, exam-safe way to state continuity without overclaiming continued central strength.
- **C.** Wrong: Persian chancery record-keeping continued within successor states.
- **D.** Wrong: successor rulers combined practical autonomy with continued use of Mughal titles and sanction.

Trap logic: Stating that grammar outlasted command captures continuity precisely, without overclaiming enforcement strength.

Q31. What is the most defensible final qualified verdict on the 1707-1740s?

What is the most defensible final qualified verdict on the 1707-1740s?

A. The century was uniformly empty of political order B. Only individual personalities explain the century's history C. The period saw declining central capacity and uneven regional reorganisation, not one monocausal collapse D. The century was uniformly prosperous everywhere

Answer: C.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong: regional order (Bengal, Awadh, Hyderabad, Maratha polities) was often robust, not absent.
- **B.** Wrong: over-personalises a structural, multi-causal historical process.
- **C.** Correct: naming both decline and reorganisation together is the safest, most complete final verdict.
- **D.** Wrong: overstates continuity while ignoring genuine war damage and political disruption.

Trap logic: The safest final verdict names two linked processes - decline and reorganisation - together, never just one alone.

Q32. What did the 1717 farman granted by Farrukhsiyar to the English East India Company establish?

What did the 1717 farman granted by Farrukhsiyar to the English East India Company establish?

A. Formal territorial sovereignty over Bengal for the Company B. The immediate cause of the Battle of Plassey C. Abolition of Mughal customs administration in Bengal D. Duty-free customs trading privileges for Company commerce in Bengal

Answer: D.

Explanation by option:

- **A.** Wrong: territorial sovereignty came only much later, well beyond 1717 and beyond this topic's ownership.
- **B.** Wrong: conflates a 1717 commercial concession with the 1757 military-political event owned by Modern History Topic 04.
- **C.** Wrong: Mughal customs administration continued; the farman granted a privilege within it, not its abolition.
- **D.** Correct: the farman granted duty-free/customs trading privileges, a commercial concession within Mughal authority.

Trap logic: A commercial trading concession is not the same as a grant of sovereignty or a direct cause of later conquest.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

PART II - VERIFIED/ROUTED PYQS WITH SOLUTIONS

PYQ 01 - 2021 Prelims GS-I Q48: eighteenth-century successor states

Verified question: With reference to Indian history, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. The Nizamat of Arcot emerged out of Hyderabad State.
2. The Mysore Kingdom emerged out of Vijayanagara Empire.
3. Rohilkhand Kingdom was formed out of the territories occupied by Ahmad Shah Durrani.

- A. 1 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 3 only

INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED LOCALLY: B, 1 and 2 only. Confidence: high. The repository routing verifies the question, but a locally readable UPSC key is unavailable.

Routing note: The direct owner is Modern History Topic 02. It is retained here only as a verified adjacent/regional-proof item because it tests eighteenth-century successor-state genealogy adjoining this topic's core.

Solved explanation

- Statement 1 is correct in the conventional successor-state genealogy: Arcot or the Carnatic operated under the Deccan/Hyderabad subordination before its nawabs acquired practical autonomy.
- Statement 2 is correct: the Wodeyar kingdom of Mysore emerged from the political field of the Vijayanagara order.
- Statement 3 is incorrect: Rohilla power in Rohilkhand grew from Afghan military settlement and weakening Mughal authority before Ahmad Shah Durrani's major Indian interventions; Durrani did not create it from his occupied territories.
- Topic significance: the question tests whether eighteenth-century states are traced to their correct imperial or regional predecessor and whether later Afghan intervention is projected backward.

Why this earns marks: It evaluates each statement independently, supplies the political genealogy and marks the unavailable official key rather than presenting an inference as official.

Demand decoding: Treat "PYQ 01 - 2021 Prelims GS-I Q48: eighteenth-century successor states" as a statement-level chronology and attribution problem: verify every date, Act/provision, person, organisation, region and causal claim independently, without inventing an official key.

Detailed examiner-grade model status: The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the tested time window; separate event/enactment/commencement; match each actor and provision; eliminate the closest distractor with one named record, treaty, session or regional fact.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ 01 - 2021 Prelims GS-I Q48: eighteenth-century successor states", add one explicit line showing why the nearest distractor fails on date, legal status, geography, attribution or degree.

PYQ 02 - 2021 Prelims GS-I Q45: Mughal administrative hierarchy

Verified question: With reference to medieval India, which one of the following is the correct sequence in ascending order in terms of size?

- A. Paragana - Sarkar - Suba
- B. Sarkar - Paragana - Suba
- C. Suba - Sarkar - Paragana
- D. Paragana - Suba - Sarkar

INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED LOCALLY: A, Paragana - Sarkar - Suba. Confidence: high.

Routing note: The direct owner is Medieval History Topic 16. It is retained here only as inherited institutional context, since Topic 01 uses the subah-sarkar-pargana grid without owning its administrative history.

Solved explanation

- A pargana grouped villages and formed the smaller revenue-administrative unit in this sequence.
- A sarkar grouped parganas.
- A subah was the larger province containing sarkars.
- Topic significance: the hierarchy is the territorial skeleton inherited in 1707. Decline occurred when provincial and local officers appropriated power inside this structure, not because the hierarchy instantly disappeared.

Why this earns marks: It gives the exact ascending order and links the fact to the mechanism of provincial autonomy rather than treating it as isolated recall.

Demand decoding: Treat "PYQ 02 - 2021 Prelims GS-I Q45: Mughal administrative hierarchy" as a statement-level chronology and attribution problem: verify every date, Act/provision, person, organisation, region and causal claim independently, without inventing an official key.

Detailed examiner-grade model status: The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the tested time window; separate event/enactment/commencement; match each actor and provision; eliminate the closest distractor with one named record, treaty, session or regional fact.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ 02 - 2021 Prelims GS-I Q45: Mughal administrative hierarchy", add one explicit line showing why the nearest distractor fails on date, legal status, geography, attribution or degree.

PYQ 03 - 2022 GS-I Mains Q2: Company armies and Indian rulers

Verified adjacent question: Why did the armies of the British East India Company - mostly comprising Indian soldiers - win consistently against the more numerous and better equipped armies of the then Indian rulers? Give reasons. (10 marks, 150 words)

Routing note: The direct owner is Modern History Topic 05. It is included here only as a verified bounded consequence because the 1707-1740s transition created a competitive multi-state field; it did not itself make Company victory inevitable.

Model answer

The Company's victories arose less from the ethnicity of its soldiers than from the organisation that converted them into a reliable fiscal-military force. Indian rulers inherited capable cavalry, artillery and revenue systems, but their armies were often composite contingents tied to chiefs. The Mughal experience at **Karnal (1739)** shows how divided command could neutralise numerical strength; Maratha confederate chiefs and successor states later faced similar coordination problems.

By contrast, the Company combined regular drill, standardised infantry-artillery coordination and promotion within a single command. Its coastal bases and naval network sustained supply, while London and Indian merchant credit financed long campaigns. Political intelligence and alliances divided opponents. After **Plassey (1757)** and the **Diwani (1765)**, Bengal revenue funded further war.

Yet victory was contingent: Mysore, Marathas and Sikhs repeatedly imposed serious reverses. The decisive advantage was a cumulative organisation-credit-revenue system, not inherent European bravery or Indian military incapacity.

Why this earns marks: It answers "why" through six mechanisms, uses Karnal only as bounded background, names Plassey and Diwani as later fiscal turning points, and qualifies inevitability with Indian resistance.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ 03 - 2022 GS-I Mains Q2: Company armies and Indian rulers", coverage of every clause, chronological-causal analysis, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model status: The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For this 10-mark/150-word Mains item, open with a one-sentence thesis naming organisation over ethnicity; give one short paragraph each on Company military-fiscal organisation and on contingent limits of Indian armies; close with one sentence naming Mysore/Maratha/Sikh reverses as the qualification.

How to improve this answer: Add one named financial figure or dated credit arrangement (for example, a specific Bengal revenue-remittance figure after 1765) to make the "organisation-credit-revenue system" claim verifiable rather than a general summary.

PYQ coverage conclusion

The audited repository routes for this exact topic (2018-2026) confirm zero direct CSE Prelims or Mains question owned by Modern History Topic 01 in this window, and no direct 2026 question exists either. The three items above are retained only as bounded adjacent evidence with their correct owners labelled: PYQ 01 (2021 Prelims Q48) belongs to Modern History Topic 02, PYQ 02 (2021 Prelims Q45) belongs to Medieval History Topic 16, and PYQ 03 (2022 GS-I Mains Q2) belongs to Modern History Topic 05. This topic is adjacent to, not the direct owner of, any of the three routed items. Unavailable official objective keys remain explicitly marked INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED LOCALLY. No History Optional question is invented.

PART IV - ORIGINAL SOLVED MAINS PRACTICE

Mains 10M-1 - Distinguish between decline, decentralisation and regionalisation in the Mughal context after 1707.

Directive and limit: Answer in approximately 150 words. Use a direct thesis, evidence-linked analysis, one qualification and a reasoned verdict.

Model answer

The terms name different levels of one transition. **Decline** is the loss of enforceable authority at Delhi: repeated succession struggles, the Sayyids' deposition of Farrukhsiyar in 1719 and divided command at Karnal in 1739 show the emperor could no longer arbitrate elites or defend the frontier.

Decentralisation is the movement of revenue and appointment power from the centre to provinces. Murshid Quli Khan in Bengal, Saadat Khan in Awadh and Nizam-ul-Mulk in Hyderabad kept Mughal offices but made collection, command and succession regional.

Regionalisation goes further: governors, zamindars, bankers and military groups formed durable political arenas - Bengal's zamindars and Jagat Seth finance, Maratha chauth networks, and Jat-Sikh mobilisation below Delhi.

The processes overlapped but were not identical. Coin, khutba, Persian chancery and imperial confirmation survived, so force shifted before legitimacy disappeared: decline at the centre, decentralisation of functions, uneven regionalisation of power.

Why this earns marks: It defines all three terms, supplies three distinct evidence clusters, shows overlap without collapsing categories and ends with a precise two-level verdict.

Demand decoding: ‘Distinguish' requires three separately defined terms, not one blended definition; each term needs its own named evidence and the answer must end by relating, not merging, the three levels.

Detailed examiner-grade model status: Preserve the three-part Decline / Decentralisation / Regionalisation structure exactly, and the closing line separating shifted political force from surviving legitimacy.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For this 10-mark/150-word item, open with one sentence naming all three terms as levels of one transition; give each term one two-line evidence-linked definition; close with one qualifying sentence on what survived.

How to improve this answer: Add one explicit dated marker for ‘regionalisation' (for example, the 1720s-30s consolidation of Jat power) so the third term has as precise a chronological anchor as decline and decentralisation already have.

Mains 10M-3 - Explain why the invasion of Nadir Shah was an exposure rather than the origin of Mughal decline.

Directive and limit: Answer in approximately 150 words. Use a direct thesis, evidence-linked analysis, one qualification and a reasoned verdict.

Model answer

Nadir Shah's invasion was possible because the imperial system had already weakened. Before 1739, Farrukhsiyar had been deposed by noble kingmakers; Nizam-ul-Mulk had converted Deccan office into Hyderabad autonomy in 1724; Bengal and Awadh retained revenue; and mansabdars often failed to maintain full contingents as jagir yields and cash were unreliable.

The frontier reproduced this failure. Delhi did not convert Nadir's repeated embassies or the fall of Qandahar and Kabul into reinforcement. At **Karnal, 24 February 1739**, Muhammad Shah's nobles disputed command; Saadat Khan engaged without an integrated plan, Khan-i-Dauran was mortally wounded, and Nadir's unified force prevailed.

The invasion still accelerated decline: Delhi suffered massacre and plunder, the emperor ceded lands west of the Indus, and prestige collapsed. Yet Muhammad Shah remained emperor and Mughal legitimacy survived.

Karnal was therefore an X-ray of a prior fiscal-command crisis, not its original disease.

Why this earns marks: It proves pre-existing weakness with four named units, explains Karnal's mechanism, gives real consequences and avoids minimising the invasion.

Demand decoding: ‘Explain why' requires a causal argument, not a narrative retelling of the invasion: the answer must show pre-existing weakness, the invasion's mechanism, and its consequences, in that order.

Detailed examiner-grade model status: Preserve the three-stage structure (pre-1739 weakness -> Karnal mechanism -> post-1739 consequences) and the closing ‘X-ray... not its original disease' verdict line.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For this 10-mark/150-word item, use a one-sentence thesis, one short paragraph of dated pre-1739 evidence, one short paragraph on Karnal's command failure, one short paragraph on consequences and throne survival, and a single-line verdict.

How to improve this answer: Name one additional pre-1739 fiscal indicator (a specific province's arrears or a jama-hasil shortfall instance) so ‘the imperial system had already weakened' rests on a named case, not only political anecdote.

Mains 15M-1 - Critically examine the jagirdari-agrarian crisis as an explanation of Mughal decline.

Directive and limit: Answer in approximately 250 words. Use a direct thesis, evidence-linked analysis, one qualification and a reasoned verdict.

Model answer

The jagirdari-agrarian thesis is powerful because it links elite politics, rural extraction and military weakness, but it must be regionally qualified.

Institutional mechanism: Satish Chandra argues that mansab and salary claims outgrew dependable assignments. *Be-jagiri*, competition for productive jagirs and the diversion of khalisa weakened the centre's cash. The **jama-hasil** gap meant that paper assessment did not equal realised revenue.

Rural transmission: Frequent transfer encouraged short-term extraction. Bipan Chandra notes the spread of **ijara**, under which contractors promised a fixed sum and sought profit from cultivators. Irfan Habib connects high surplus demand to peasant flight, arrears and zamindar-led Jat, Sikh and other resistance.

Military consequence: Nobles with inadequate income did not maintain full contingents. Thus fiscal weakness reduced coercion; weaker coercion further reduced collection. Court parties then recruited followers by promising ranks and jagirs, as in the Farrukhsiyar-Sayyid conflict.

Qualifications: John F. Richards asks whether Deccan revenues and khalisa choices made part of the scarcity policy-produced. Muzaffar Alam and C.A. Bayly point to agrarian growth, monetisation, bankers and regional states, showing that resources were redistributed rather than universally destroyed. Bengal's strong collection under Murshid Quli Khan is counter-evidence to an all-India production collapse, although it could burden smaller zamindars and peasants.

Therefore the crisis is best treated as a variable mechanism: assignment, extraction and service diverged, but the degree and social outcome differed across regions.

Why this earns marks: It defines the mechanism, uses Chandra, Habib, Richards and revisionist counter-evidence, connects fiscal and military outcomes and gives a qualified rather than absolute verdict.

Demand decoding: ‘Critically examine' requires stating the thesis's strength, its evidentiary mechanism and at least one named scholarly qualification, ending in a reasoned verdict rather than flat endorsement or rejection.

Detailed examiner-grade model status: Preserve the four labelled sub-sections (Institutional mechanism / Rural transmission / Military consequence / Qualifications) and the named-scholar attributions exactly.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For this 15-mark/250-word item, use a one-sentence thesis, roughly 60 words per labelled sub-section, and a qualification paragraph naming at least two scholars before a single-sentence verdict.

How to improve this answer: Add one specific regional hasil-shortfall figure or a dated ijara-contracting instance so the ‘rural transmission' paragraph rests on a named case rather than a general mechanism statement.

Mains 15M-3 - How far was Aurangzeb responsible for the decline of the Mughal Empire?

Directive and limit: Answer in approximately 250 words. Use a direct thesis, evidence-linked analysis, one qualification and a reasoned verdict.

Model answer

Aurangzeb was substantially responsible for intensifying the empire's constraints, but he cannot be made the single cause of a decline worked out after 1707.

Real responsibility: The long Deccan commitment absorbed treasury and troops, added difficult territories and failed to extinguish Maratha mobility. Incorporating Deccani and Maratha entrants increased claims on mansabs and jagirs. The emperor's prolonged southern presence weakened supervision of the north and northwest. Conflict over Marwar damaged a Rajput alliance central to Mughal power; jizya and some temple policies narrowed legitimacy in places.

Necessary qualification: Bipan Chandra notes that administration, army and dynastic prestige remained substantial at Aurangzeb's death. Religious measures were reversed: Bahadur Shah and later the Sayyids restored broad accommodation, while Hindu and Muslim nobles repeatedly allied across faith for office and revenue.

Post-1707 mechanisms: Succession wars killed commanders and made noble coalitions decisive. The Sayyids deposed Farrukhsiyar; Nizam-ul-Mulk regionalised Deccan power; jagir and agrarian pressures weakened contingents; Bengal and Awadh retained revenue; and Muhammad Shah's nobles failed to coordinate at Karnal.

Jadunath Sarkar's ruler-centred reading therefore identifies important agency but becomes inadequate when communal or moral blame replaces institutional evidence. Satish Chandra's jagirdari-Deccan synthesis better explains transmission.

Aurangzeb aggravated the inheritance; later fiscal, political and regional choices converted strain into systemic decline.

Why this earns marks: It answers 'how far' with concession, qualification and ranking; uses Deccan, Rajput, jizya, Sayyids, successor states and Karnal; and attributes historiography accurately.

Demand decoding: ‘How far' requires an explicit degree judgment, not a yes/no answer: a concession paragraph, a qualification paragraph and a post-1707 mechanism paragraph must together rank Aurangzeb's share of responsibility against later actors.

Detailed examiner-grade model status: Preserve the three-part structure (Real responsibility / Necessary qualification / Post-1707 mechanisms) and the closing ranking of Sarkar's reading against Satish Chandra's.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For this 15-mark/250-word item, use a thesis sentence stating ‘substantial but not sole', one paragraph of Deccan/Rajput/jizya evidence, one paragraph of continuity/reversal evidence, one paragraph on post-1707 transmission, and a closing historiographical ranking sentence.

How to improve this answer: Name the specific year and actor of jizya's reversal so the ‘reversed' claim is independently verifiable rather than a general assertion.

Mains 20M-1 - Why did Mughal central authority decline between 1707 and the 1740s? Present a weighted multi-causal explanation.

Directive and limit: Answer in approximately 250 words. Use a direct thesis, evidence-linked analysis, one qualification and a reasoned verdict.

Model answer

Mughal central authority declined because the fiscal-military contract joining emperor, nobility, province and countryside stopped reproducing revenue and service - a deeper interactive crisis, not one cause.

1. Inherited over-extension: Aurangzeb left a formidable empire, but the long Deccan war tied down forces and never ended Maratha mobility - a difficult inheritance, not inevitable collapse.

2. Succession and arbitration: With no fixed rule, Jajau in 1707 and later contests drained soldiers and made the throne depend on noble coalitions; Farrukhsiyar's 1719 deposition showed kingmakers could control monarchy.

3. Jagirdari-fiscal mechanism: Satish Chandra's *be-jagiri* thesis links growing claimants to inadequate assignments. Jama exceeded hasil; ijara contractors pressed cultivators; nobles in arrears kept incomplete contingents.

4. Agrarian and regional feedback: Irfan Habib links extraction to peasant and zamindar resistance; Jats, Sikhs and Bundelas withheld revenue. Yet Murshid Quli Khan's Bengal stayed fiscally vigorous as remittance fell.

5. Provincial and Maratha reordering: Saadat Khan's Awadh and Nizam-ul-Mulk's Hyderabad converted office into autonomy while keeping legitimacy; Maratha chauth and sardeshmukhi shifted from exaction to bargaining after 1718-19.

6. Military-command failure: The army kept artillery and numbers, but paper mansabs and factional command cut usable strength; at Karnal (1739) divided command met Nadir's mobility.

7. External shock: Nadir's victory and loss west of the Indus devastated prestige, though weakness predated it.

The order is weighted: fiscal-military and political structures formed the core; rural and regional movements amplified them; military failure transmitted them; Nadir fixed the timing - central decline with uneven transition, not instant disappearance.

Why this earns marks: It gives a ranked mechanism rather than a list, uses more than eight named evidence units, separates inherited strain from post-1707 transmission, integrates revisionist counter-evidence and ends with a level-specific verdict.

Demand decoding: ‘Present a weighted multi-causal explanation' requires an explicit ranking across at least five named mechanisms, each with its own evidence, followed by a single ranked-synthesis sentence, not a flat list of factors.

Detailed examiner-grade model status: Preserve the seven numbered causal layers exactly as ordered (inherited over-extension through external shock) and the final ranked-synthesis sentence.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For this 20-mark/250-word item, use a two-sentence thesis, roughly 30 words per numbered layer, and reserve the final two to three sentences for the explicit weighting statement.

How to improve this answer: Add one explicit sentence naming which of the seven layers is treated as first-order/structural versus amplifying, since the current version ranks mainly through ordering rather than stating the ranking rule outright.

Mains 20M-2 - Was the eighteenth century in India a 'dark age' of decline or an age of regional transformation? Critically discuss with reference to 1707-1740s.

Directive and limit: Answer in approximately 250 words. Use a direct thesis, evidence-linked analysis, one qualification and a reasoned verdict.

Model answer

Neither label is sufficient alone. The period was a darkening of Mughal central fiscal-military capacity and, simultaneously, an uneven transformation of political and economic power toward regions.

Evidence for decline: Succession contests after 1707 empowered factions; Farrukhsiyar's deposition by the Sayyids in 1719 eroded monarchical prestige. Jagir competition, jama-hasil gaps and ijara shifted pressure onto cultivators; Jat, Sikh and zamindar resistance disrupted revenue. Provincial remittance weakened, mansabdars under-maintained contingents, and Nadir Shah's 1739 Karnal victory brought massacre, plunder and frontier loss. Older, Jadunath-Sarkar-style narratives read this through Aurangzeb and moral-political decay - preserving chronology but risking court conduct as complete causation.

Evidence for transformation: Bengal under Murshid Quli Khan built a strong revenue order backed by zamindars and bankers. Saadat Khan's Awadh and Nizam-ul-Mulk's Hyderabad kept Mughal titles, coins and khutba while regionalising force and revenue. Maratha chauth and sardeshmukhi grew into a wide political system; Jats and Sikhs built durable local mobilisation. Muzaffar Alam and C.A. Bayly stress decentralisation, regional politics and "portfolio" resources; cultural life at Muhammad Shah's Delhi and its movement to regional courts contradicts total collapse.

Social and regional qualification: Regional vitality could rest on coercive collection - Murshid Quli's efficient Bengal disadvantaged smaller zamindars, and warfare exposed peasants. Delhi's recovery cannot represent every

devastated corridor.

The best synthesis is two-level: the imperial centre declined catastrophically while authority, commerce and culture reorganised through regions unequally. "Transition" is the broader category; "decline" remains indispensable for Delhi's lost capacity.

Why this earns marks: It constructs and tests both sides with political, fiscal, regional, economic and cultural evidence; names historiographical positions; adds social costs; and delivers a non-evasive critical verdict.

Demand decoding: ‘Critically discuss' requires constructing evidence for both the ‘dark age' and ‘transformation' readings before delivering a non-evasive synthesis verdict; listing only decline evidence is insufficient.

Detailed examiner-grade model status: Preserve the four-part structure (Evidence for decline / Evidence for transformation / Social and regional qualification / synthesis) and the named Sarkar-versus-Alam/Bayly contrast.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For this 20-mark/250-word item, use a thesis sentence rejecting both labels alone, roughly 65-70 words per evidence side, a short social-cost qualification sentence, and a closing synthesis naming ‘transition' as the broader category.

How to improve this answer: Add one named material-culture or price/wage data point to the ‘evidence for transformation' paragraph, since it currently relies mainly on political-administrative and cultural evidence rather than economic data.